

Hermes and the Lyre

*Maia was an ocean nymph,
daughter of the Titans Atlas and Pleione.
Together, she and Zeus had a son
named Hermes.*

Hermes was a particularly mischievous child. In fact, he grew up to be the god of tricksters. One day, he escaped from Maia and decided to steal a herd of prized cows from his half brother, the god Apollo.

So that Apollo could not find the cows, Hermes cast a spell on them so that they could only walk backward.

When Apollo found his field empty of cattle, he went to look at their hoofprints, but he could not figure out where they had gone. The prints led into the field, but his cows were nowhere to be seen.

While Apollo was puzzling over his missing cattle, Hermes had sacrificed one of the cows to the older gods and cut up its body into pieces. When he was looking at its intestines, he was struck by an

Hermes enchanted the cows to walk backward.

